XAVIER'S PREMIER LEAGUE 2026

RULES AND REGULATIONS

OPENING NOTE

Hello everyone, and welcome back! Thank you to all for participating in the Xavier's Premier League 2026.

Following the success of XPL 2025, we are back with a better and bigger XPL 2026. While the fundamentals of the competition remain the same, we have added new features and improvements to the competition that will require more strategy from the participants, provide more opportunities for scoring points, test various skills and provide an overall elevated experience.

The new marquee feature this year will be the **Betting Arena**: An added component where participants will have the opportunity to wager their points to place bets *for every match*, to score even more points and get ahead in the competition.

An improvement to last year is the addition of the **Substitute System**, which provides each participant more control over their squad to make strategic changes throughout the tournament and help cover for injuries and replacements.

The detailed rules for the Betting Arena and the Substitute System are explained later in this document.

INTRODUCTION

- There are a total of eight participants, so there would be a total of 8 squads.
- Each participant needs to create a squad of **exactly 25** players, by buying players at the XPL auction.
- The total purse available for creating a squad is 12,500 lacs (125 crores)
- The players available for the auction would be the ones in the ten IPL squads for IPL 2026.
- Every player goes to one participant's squad only, so every squad would be distinct, and no players will overlap across squads.
- The players would receive fantasy points according to the XPL point system.
- The points scored by all the players in the squad across all the matches will be added up for the **Fantasy Score**.
- The points scored by participants in the Betting Arena through placing bets throughout the tournament will be added up for the **Betting Score**
- The participant with the highest aggregate of **Fantasy Score** and **Betting Score** will be crowned the **XPL 2026 Champion!**

PLAYER DISTRIBUTION

- There are a total of **250 players** across the 10 IPL franchises that will be a part of the IPL 2026, and will be up for grabs for XPL 2026
- The participants have already made their choices for retentions, as **19 players have been retained** across the 8 squads
- **231 players** will be going under the hammer at the XPL 2026 auction
- The player distribution in the auction is as follows:

	Batters	Wicket Keepers	All Rounders	Bowlers	Total
Capped*	12	3	10	28	53
Overseas**	9	14	25	27	75
Uncapped	24	11	26	42	103
Total	45	28	61	97	**231**

*Capped players refer to Indian capped players

**Overseas players refer to all overseas players, capped or uncapped

SQUAD REQUIREMENTS

- Each squad must meet the following requirements:
  - **Exactly** 25 total players
  - **Maximum** 9 overseas players
  - **Minimum** 3 batters
  - **Minimum** 2 wicket keepers
  - **Minimum** 4 all rounders
  - **Minimum** 5 bowlers
- If any of the above requirements for a player type is not satisfied, then 10% of the fantasy points would be deducted for every missing player type.
- Each participant will name a Captain and a Vice-Captain for their squad, who will score 2x and 1.5x their fantasy points respectively

AUCTION

- The auction will occur in three phases:
  1. **Phase A**
  - This is the main phase of the auction where you strengthen up the core of your squad with the big guns!
  - All the Capped and Overseas players will go under the hammer in this phase, along with a few selected Uncapped players
  - There will be a total of **155 players across 23 sets**
  - The player list will be made available, so the order and composition of each set will be known but the order of players within each set will be randomized at the time of the auction.

- The auction list during this phase will consist of the following sets:

Category	Sets	Players
Capped Batters	2	12
Overseas Batters	1	9
Capped Wicket Keepers	1	3
Overseas Wicket Keepers	2	14
Capped All Rounders	2	10
Overseas All Rounders	5	25
Capped Bowlers	4	28
Overseas Bowlers	3	27
Uncapped Premium*	3	27
Total	23	155

*Unlike last year, a few selected uncapped players that the organizing committee believes will get bids at the auction are included in Phase A of the auction. These are not categorized by their type and are all grouped together.

2. **Phase B**

- This is the phase to find the undiscovered gems and dark horses of your squad!
- At the end of the Phase A, a list of all the uncapped players not covered in Phase A will be made available to the participants
- All participants will be asked to mark in a file if they'd like a player to appear in the auction
- Only those players that are marked by the participants will go under the hammer in this phase
- There will be a total of **76 players** in this list, and the ones marked by the participants will be grouped into sets (depending on how many are selected) and brought into the auction

3. **Phase C**:

- Missed out on someone earlier? Haven't been able to fulfil one of the requirements? This phase is the perfect opportunity to fill the gaps and fine-tune your squad!
- A list of all the unsold players from Phases A and B will be made available
- All participants will be asked to mark in a file if they'd like a player to appear in the auction
- Only those players that are marked by the participants will go under the hammer in this phase
- The players marked by the participants will be grouped into sets (depending on how many are selected) and brought into the auction

SUBSTITUTE SYSTEM

- A major improvement from last year, this new substitute system levels the playing field for all the participants, avoids any unfair advantage and helps cover up the gaps of uncertainty regarding player availability
- **Even though each squad has 25 players, only 20 players will be on the playing squad and scoring fantasy points for the squad at any given time while the remaining 5 players will be on the bench**
- Once the squads are finalized, every participant will be required to name the 20 players in their squad that they'd like to have on their playing squad at the beginning of the tournament
- Only the players in the playing squad will score fantasy points for the participant, while the players on the bench will serve as substitute options
- A player on the playing squad can be swapped out with a player on the bench at any point of time by the participant
- Unlike last year, a substitution is not restricted only to cases of a player being ruled out of the tournament
- **However, substitutions can only be made within the participant's squad and no unsold player from the auction will be available as a replacement**
- Each participant will be provided with **5 free substitutions** throughout the tournament, beyond which each substitution will come at a cost
- Beyond the 5th free substitution, each substitution will cost **30 points per match played** by the subbed in **player's team** with an **additional cost of 5 points per match played** by the subbed in **player's team** for every **subsequent substitution**
- The participants are allowed to (and encouraged to) make tactical substitutions and not just limit themselves to forced substitutions
- However, forced substitutions will not be counted separately from the tactical substitutions and they all will come under the same umbrella
- Each participant needs to manage their substitutions keeping in mind the risk of forced substitutions, as any substitutions beyond the first 5 free ones will come at a cost irrespective of it being a forced substitution
- The 5 free substitutions are set keeping in mind a good enough threshold for forced substitutions, so they need to be used smartly and judiciously
- Apart from regular substitutions, participants are also **allowed to change their captain and vice-captain at any point of time**
- The changed captain or vice-captain could be any other player in their squad
- Each participant will be provided with **2 free changes to captain and vice-captain each** throughout the tournament, beyond which each change will come at a cost
- Beyond the 2nd vice-captain change, each change will cost **45 points per match played** by the new **vice-captain's team** with an **additional cost of 7.5 points per**

match played by the new **vice-captain's team** for every **subsequent change** in the vice-captain

- Beyond the 2nd captain change, each change will cost **60 points per match played** by the new **captain's team** with an **additional cost of 10 points per match played** by the new **captain's team** for every **subsequent change** in the captain
- Unlike last year, no free changes to the captain and vice-captain will be allowed at the time of playoffs
- The 2 free changes are set keeping the playoffs in mind, so they need to be managed accordingly
- The following tables show how the substitutions and the vice-captaincy/captaincy changes will be charged throughout the tournament:

Substitution #	Cost
1st Substitution	Free
2nd Substitution	Free
3rd Substitution	Free
4th Substitution	Free
5th Substitution	Free
6th Substitution	30 points per match
7th Substitution	35 points per match
8th Substitution	40 points per match
9th Substitution	45 points per match
10th Substitution	50 points per match

Vice-Captain Change #	Cost
1st Vice-Captain Change	Free
2nd Vice-Captain Change	Free
3rd Vice-Captain Change	45 points per match
4th Vice-Captain Change	52.5 points per match
5th Vice-Captain Change	60 points per match

Captain Change #	Cost
1st Captain Change	Free
2nd Captain Change	Free
3rd Captain Change	60 points per match
4th Captain Change	70 points per match
5th Captain Change	80 points per match

Important Note: Even though substitutions can be made anytime, it will be ensured by the committee that the new player's team should have played *at least* as many games as the previous player's team before the substitution comes in effect. For example, consider a scenario where Virat Kohli (RCB) is on the playing squad and KL

Rahul (DC) is on the bench. If RCB has played 5 games and DC has played 3 games when a decision is made to swap out Virat Kohli for KL Rahul, then KL Rahul **will not score** fantasy points until DC's 5th match. He will start scoring fantasy points from DC's 6th game onwards. However, in the case that RCB has played 3 games, and DC has played 5 games when Virat Kohli is swapped for KL Rahul, there will be no points backtracked for KL Rahul or Virat Kohli in RCB's or DC's 4th and 5th games. KL Rahul will start scoring points from DC's 6th game onwards. Participants need to consider these factors while making substitution decisions. The same rules apply for captaincy and vice-captaincy changes for 2x and 1.5x scoring.

BETTING ARENA

➢ **About the Betting Arena:**

- The new exciting marquee feature this year, the Betting Arena brings a new dimension to XPL and will test different skills of the participants!
- Even though the fantasy points scored by the players serve as the main source of points, the **betting points** scored through the Betting Arena will give the competitive edge over other participants
- While the fantasy points are a passive source of points with limited control, the betting points will be an active source of points throughout the tournament that can be **earned for every match** and provides more control to the participants
- **Participation is completely optional,** but it is highly encouraged as it rewards well-calculated decisions, providing an opportunity to cover up for fantasy points and moving up the table

➢ **Rules for the Betting Arena:**

- The Betting Arena works on the principle of participants wagering their points and placing bets on the **success of the event**
- Prior to every match, 4 match related scenarios will be presented to all participants
- Participants can choose to place bets and wager a custom amount of points to all the scenarios as they wish
- In case the event is a failure (i.e., it doesn't happen), the participant loses the points they had bet on that event
- In case the event is a success (i.e., it does happen), the participant earns a certain amount of points, in addition to gaining back the wagered points
- The 4 scenarios will have different likelihoods of success, and so the winnings from each one will be different in case of a success
- The 4 categories of scenarios will remain the same across all the matches:

Category	Bet Type	Range of chances of success
Play it Safe	1:2	60% - 80%
Take a shot!	1:1	45% - 55%
Is it worth it?	3:2	35% - 45%
Only if you dare!	2:1	25% - 35%

- The sum of bets across all the 4 categories should be a **maximum of 100 points**, and the bet placed in each category must be a whole number
- These 100 points (or lesser) can be distributed among the 4 categories as per the wish and risk-taking ability of the participants
- To provide an example, here's how the earnings (or loss) would look like if 10 points are wagered across all the 4 categories:

Category	Bet Type	Bet placed	Net gain if Success	Net loss if Failure
Play it Safe	1:2	10	5	-10
Take a shot!	1:1	10	10	-10
Is it worth it?	3:2	10	15	-10
Only if you dare!	2:1	10	20	-10

- As a result, the maximum number of points that can be won in a match is 200 (by placing a bet of 100 on the "Only if you dare!" category and winning it), and the maximum number of points that can be lost in a match is 100
- Some examples of scenarios that would come up are:
  - The team that wins the toss will choose to bat first
  - The team batting second will score 50+ runs in the Powerplay
  - Virat Kohli will score 30+ runs
  - There will be no runouts during the match
  - Rashid Khan will have the lowest economy rate from his side
- Here is an example of someone who wagered 80 points on a MI vs DC match and the results from it:

Category	Scenario	Bet placed	Result	Net gain
Play it Safe	Team batting first will score 150+ runs	0	Success	0
Take a shot!	Mumbai Indians will win the match	50	Failure	-50
Is it worth it?	Axar Patel will take 2+ wickets	0	Failure	0
Only if you dare!	Naman Dhir will face 10+ balls	30	Success	60

In this case, the participant wagered 80 points and made a net gain of 10 points (by winning 90 points)

- The chance of success of a scenario will be calculated based on historical data, and the scenario will be placed in an appropriate category accordingly
- In case of a shortened match, all bets will be null and void and the participants will gain back the points they had wagered

- In case a scenario is based on an individual and the individual is not in the Playing XII, that particular bet will be null and void and the participants will gain back the points they had wagered
- Bets will be open 24 hours before the match time and close an hour before the match time (half an hour before the toss time)

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